

Onboarding a New Artist to Google Calendar Sync

How to connect an artist's Google Calendar so their Booking Forms sync automatically — and how to authenticate the connection.

Applies to	Audience	Feature
Vocal Events Production & UAT	Salesforce Admin	Booking Form → Google Calendar Sync

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1. How the sync works

Three things have to line up for an artist's calendar to receive events: a field on their Artist record telling Salesforce which calendar to write to, a Named Credential that knows how to authenticate to Google, and that Named Credential being authenticated against the artist's actual Google account. This guide walks through setting all three up for a new artist.

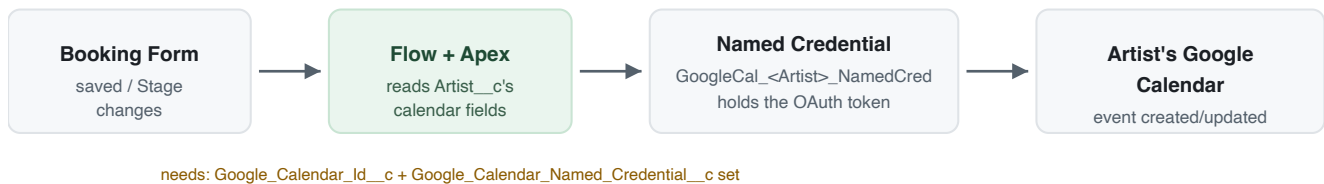


Fig. 1 — What has to be in place for a Booking Form to reach Google Calendar.

WHERE THE "ONE-TIME" WORK ALREADY HAPPENED

A shared Google Cloud OAuth Client and Salesforce Auth Provider (`GoogleCalendarAuthProvider`) were already set up once for the whole org — you don't need to touch either of those to onboard a new artist. Section 5 covers them for reference only, in case they ever need to be recreated.

2. Onboarding a new artist

Repeat this whenever a new artist needs their calendar connected. Steps 3–4 are the only ones that must be redone for every artist; Step 2 is only needed the first time an artist is connected.

1

Get the artist's Google Calendar email address

This is the Gmail account whose calendar will show their shows — usually the same account Vocal Events already logs into on their behalf. Confirm it directly with the artist or agent if you're not sure; writing the wrong address here means events go to the wrong calendar.

2

Only for a brand-new artist: create their Named Credential pair

Each artist needs their own Named Credential + External Credential pair — this is what lets Salesforce authenticate to their specific Google account separately from everyone else's. You do this entirely from Setup, no developer needed. If two artists share one calendar (e.g. a duo act), skip this step and reuse an existing pair instead — see Section 5's table for what already exists.

BEFORE YOU START: KEEP A WORKING EXAMPLE OPEN

Open **Setup** → **Named Credentials** → **External Credentials** → **GoogleCal_RicusNel_ExtCred** in another tab. You'll copy its settings exactly — this protects you if a field label below reads slightly differently on your screen than it does here (Setup's exact wording can shift between Salesforce releases).

2a. Create the External Credential — Setup → Named Credentials → **External Credentials** tab → New:

FIELD	VALUE
Label	Google Calendar - <Artist Name>
Name	GoogleCal_<ArtistKey>_ExtCred — no spaces, must match this pattern exactly
Authentication Protocol	OAuth 2.0
Identity Provider	Google Calendar Auth Provider — the one shared org-wide provider, already set up; you're just pointing at it, not creating a new one
Authentication Flow Type	Browser Flow
Scope	leave blank — it's already defined on the Auth Provider itself

Save.

2b. Add a Principal — on the External Credential you just saved, scroll to the **Principals** related list → New:

FIELD	VALUE
Parameter Name	<ArtistKey>Principal — any label is fine, just make it recognizable
Identity Type	Named Principal

Save — but don't click Authenticate yet, that's Step 4, once the Artist record is set up too.

2c. Create the matching Named Credential — Setup → Named Credentials → **Named Credentials** tab → New:

FIELD	VALUE
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Label	Google Calendar - <Artist Name>
Name	GoogleCal_<ArtistKey>_NamedCred — same <ArtistKey> as Step 2a
URL	https://www.googleapis.com/calendar/v3
External Credential	the one you created in Step 2a
Generate Authorization Header	checked

Save. That full name from Step 2c — e.g. GoogleCal_RicusNel_NamedCred — is what goes into the Artist record in Step 3.

2d. Grant access to the Principal — creating a Principal in 2b doesn't automatically let anyone use it. Whoever needs to authenticate it (Step 4) or troubleshoot it later needs explicit access, granted from a Profile or Permission Set:

FIELD	VALUE
Where	Setup → Profiles (or Permission Sets) → the admin's Profile/Permission Set → External Credential Principal Access (under Apps)
Action	Edit → select <ArtistKey>Principal on the left → Add → Save

PROFILE GRANTS DON'T SHOW UP IN METADATA

Granting this on a **Profile** (e.g. System Administrator) works fine day-to-day, but Salesforce doesn't expose Profile-level External Credential Principal Access through the Metadata API at all — it can't be deployed or version-controlled, so it has to be redone by hand in every org (a new sandbox, a fresh Production org, etc). Granting it on a **Permission Set** instead behaves identically for the user but *is* deployable — worth doing that way if you want this step to survive a sandbox refresh without re-doing it.

NEW EXTERNAL CREDENTIAL

Label

Google Calendar - Ricus Nel

Name

GoogleCal_RicusNel_ExtCred

Authentication Protocol

OAuth 2.0

Identity Provider

Google Calendar Auth Provider

Authentication Flow Type

Browser Flow

NEW NAMED CREDENTIAL

Name

GoogleCal_RicusNel_NamedCred

URL

googleapis.com/calendar/v3

External Credential

GoogleCal_RicusNel_ExtCred

PRINCIPALS (on the External Credential)

RicusNelPrincipal · Named Principal

Save here - Authenticate happens in Step 4

Fig. 2 — The three things you create in Setup for a new artist (illustrative, not a live screenshot — double-check field wording against an existing pair, as noted above).

EXTERNAL CREDENTIAL PRINCIPAL ACCESS — EDIT

Available

DannySmokePrincipal

DassiePrincipal

...

Add →

Enabled

RicusNelPrincipal

Repeat this once per new Principal you create in Step 2b — existing ones already granted stay as they are.

Fig. 3 — Moving a new Principal into the Enabled column (illustrative, not a live screenshot).

3 Fill in the two fields on the Artist record

Open the artist in Salesforce and set:

FIELD	VALUE
Google Calendar Id	the Gmail address from Step 1
Google Calendar Named Credential	the exact API name from Step 2c, e.g. GoogleCal_RicusNel_NamedCred

ARTIST RECORD — DETAIL

Google Calendar Id

ricusnel7@gmail.com

Google Calendar Named Credential

GoogleCal_RicusNel_NamedCred

Google Calendar Status

Never Synced

read-only — set automatically once the sync runs

Fig. 4 — Example of the two fields filled in on an Artist record (illustrative, not a live screenshot).

4 Authenticate the Named Credential

This is the step that actually links Salesforce to the artist's Google account. It has to be done once per artist by whoever is logged into that artist's Gmail (usually you, on Vocal Events' shared devices).

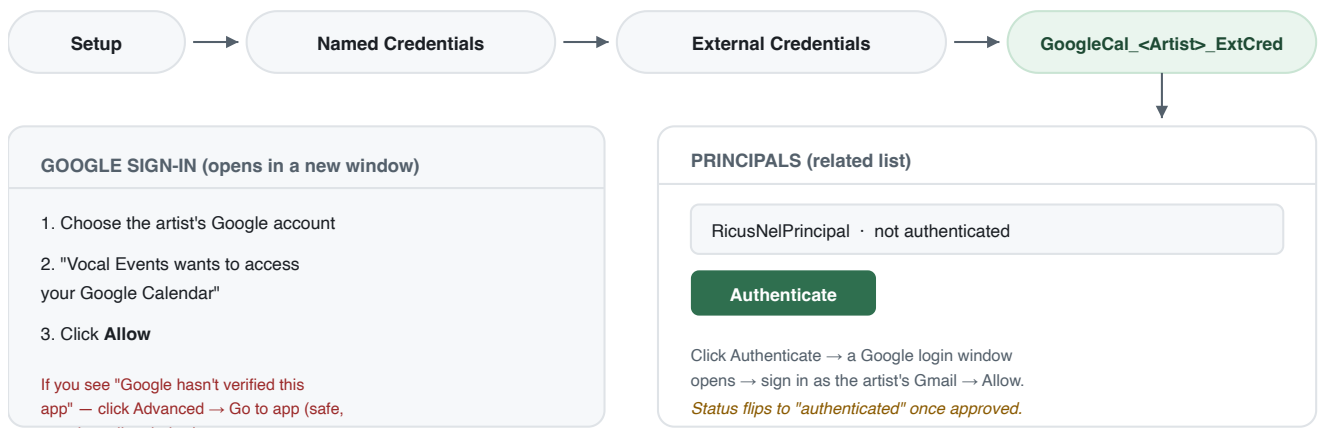


Fig. 5 — Setup navigation and the Google consent step (illustrative, not a live screenshot).

"GOOGLE HASN'T VERIFIED THIS APP" WARNING

This is expected and safe to click through — Vocal Events' Google Cloud project hasn't gone through Google's full public-app verification, since only Vocal Events' own artist accounts ever authenticate against it. Click **Advanced**, then **Go to Vocal Events (unsafe)**, then continue to **Allow**. If this warning doesn't appear at all, that's fine too — it only shows for accounts that haven't consented before.

5 Optional: backfill the artist's existing bookings

New artists onboarded going forward will sync automatically the moment a Booking Form is created or changes. If the artist already has upcoming (or past) Booking Forms that should also show on their calendar, ask your developer to run:

```
Database.executeBatch(new GoogleCalendarInitialSyncBatch(artistId), 25);
```

— scoped to just that artist, so it only touches their bookings.

3. Verifying it worked

The **Vocal Events Google Calendar Sync Dashboard** gives an at-a-glance view of every artist's connection status. Find it under the **Public Dashboards** folder in the Dashboards tab.

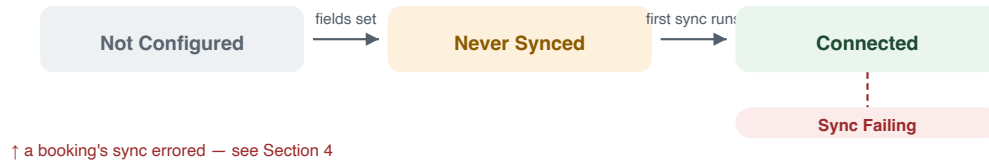


Fig. 6 — Expected status progression for a newly-onboarded artist.

To confirm end-to-end: create a test Booking Form for the artist (Stage = New) and check their calendar for an all-day event titled "{Town} – TBC". Move the Stage to Confirmed and confirm the title updates to just "{Town}". Cancel it and confirm the event disappears.

4. Troubleshooting

An artist shows "Sync Failing" on the dashboard

Open one of their affected Booking Forms and check the `Google Calendar Sync Error` field — it holds the exact error from the last failed attempt. Common causes:

SYMPTOM	LIKELY CAUSE
401 / invalid_grant errors	The artist revoked access, or hasn't re-authenticated after changing their Google password — redo Step 4.
404 on update	Self-healing — the sync recreates the event automatically on the next attempt.
Error mentions the Named Credential name	Check <code>Google Calendar Named Credential</code> on the Artist record for a typo.

You should already be getting an email about failures

Any sync failure automatically emails whoever is set in `Vocal Events Settings → Integration Alerts Email` (Setup → Custom Settings → Vocal Events Settings → Manage → Org Default). If that's not populated yet, failures won't be emailed anywhere — they'll only be visible on the dashboard and on the individual Booking Form.

Retrying every currently-failing booking at once

Ask your developer to run:

```
Database.executeBatch(new GoogleCalendarInitialSyncBatch(null, true), 25);
```

This re-attempts every booking currently marked as failing, across all artists, without touching anything that's already working.

5. Current artist reference table

The Named Credential / External Credential pair already created for each artist as of this integration's rollout. Reuse the matching pair rather than creating a new one for these artists.

ARTIST	NAMED CREDENTIAL
Danny Smoke	<code>GoogleCal_DannySmoke_NamedCred</code>
Dassie	<code>GoogleCal_Dassie_NamedCred</code>
FATMAN	<code>GoogleCal_FATMAN_NamedCred</code>
Hammie / Annarie (Hamilton Wessels)	<code>GoogleCal_HammieAnnarie_NamedCred</code>
Jakkals Vibes	<code>GoogleCal_JakkalsVibes_NamedCred</code>
Liza Nel	<code>GoogleCal_Liza_NamedCred</code>
PROP	<code>GoogleCal_PROP_NamedCred</code>
Reandi Grey	<code>GoogleCal_ReandiGrey_NamedCred</code>
Ricus Nel	<code>GoogleCal_RicusNel_NamedCred</code>
Rooksein	<code>GoogleCal_Rooksein_NamedCred</code>

One-time org setup (reference only)

These were already configured once for the whole org and shouldn't need to change when onboarding an artist. Recorded here in case this ever needs rebuilding (e.g. a sandbox refresh):

ITEM	VALUE / LOCATION
Auth Provider	<code>GoogleCalendarAuthProvider</code> (Setup → Auth. Providers)
OAuth scope	<code>openid email profile https://www.googleapis.com/auth/calendar.events</code>
Authorize URL params	<code>access_type=offline&prompt=consent</code> — required so Google actually issues a refresh token
Callback URL (per org)	<code>https://<My Domain>/services/authcallback/GoogleCalendarAuthProvider</code> — register this in the Google Cloud OAuth Client for each org (Production, UAT, etc.)
Alerts recipient	<code>Vocal Events Settings → Integration Alerts Email</code> (Custom Setting, Org Default)